

Retail Superstore Sales Performance Analysis

SQL + Power BI

Presented by
Busayo Omoniyi

Project Overview

TOOLS:

SQL
Power BI
Excel

DATASET:
Global Superstore

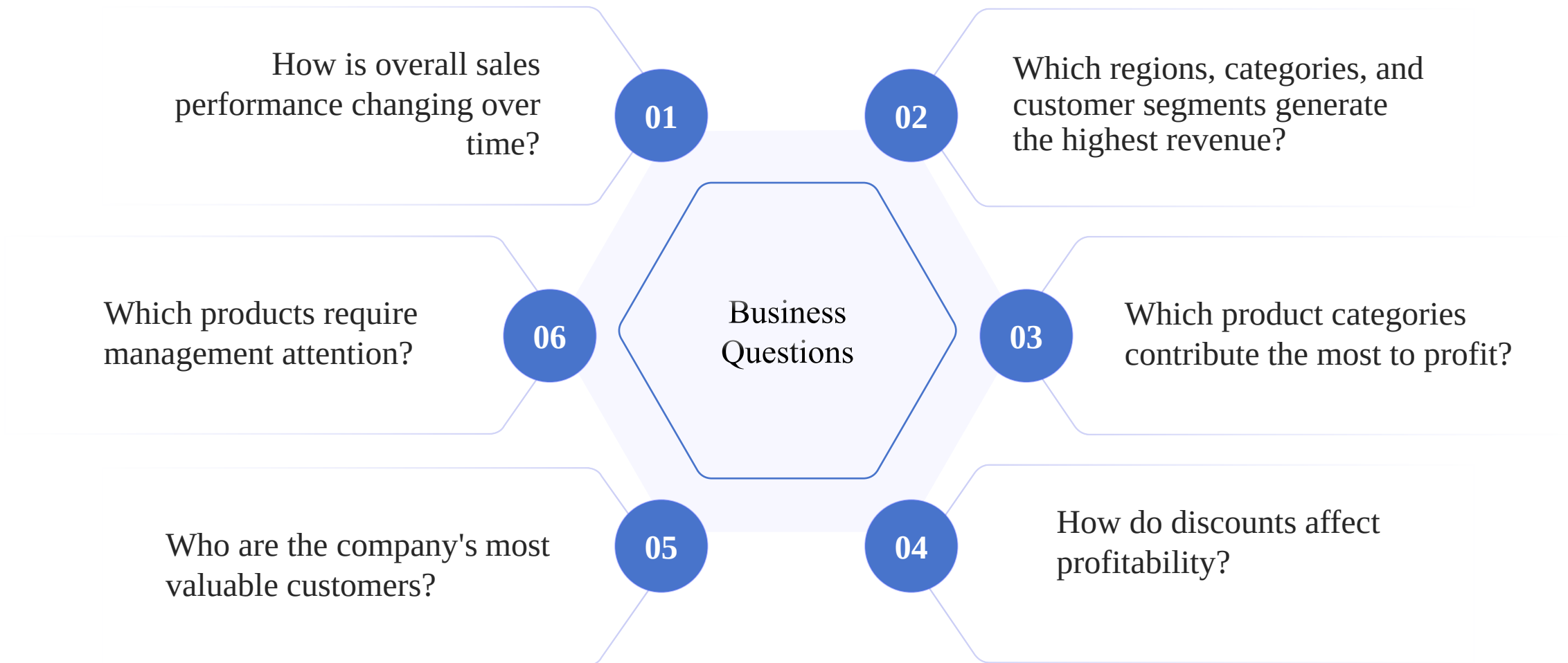
ROLE:
Data Analyst

Global Superstore wanted to understand how its sales performance, profitability, customer behavior, and product performance changed over time.

Using SQL for data analysis and Power BI for visualization, I analyzed transactional data to identify trends, uncover business opportunities, and provide actionable recommendations that support better decision-making.

Objective

Transform raw sales data into meaningful business insights through data cleaning, SQL analysis, interactive dashboards, and data storytelling.



This analysis was conducted to answer the above business questions

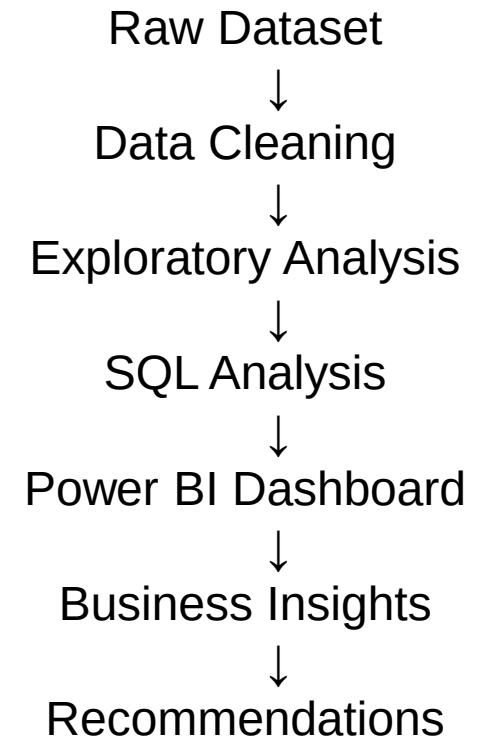
Data Understanding and Preparation

Before beginning the analysis, the dataset was explored to understand its structure, data types, and overall quality.

The preparation process included:

1. Reviewing all variables and their business meaning
2. Identifying missing values and inconsistencies
3. Cleaning and standardizing the dataset
4. Preparing the data for SQL analysis and Power BI visualization

This ensured the analysis was based on reliable and consistent data.



SQL Analysis

SQL was used to explore the dataset, answer key business questions, and prepare insights for visualization.

The analysis focused on:

Sales performance

01

Product performance

04

Profitability

02

Discount impact

05

Customer behavior

03

Time-based trends

06

The resulting insights formed the foundation of the interactive Power BI dashboard.

Executive Insight

Business Question 1: How is the business performing overall?

Finding

Sales increased steadily between 2011 and 2014, with 2014 recording the strongest overall performance. The business also exhibits a clear seasonal trend, as Q4, particularly November and December, consistently generated the highest sales, with November 2014 reaching a peak of 555,312.

Business Impact

The recurring Q4 sales surge presents an opportunity to maximize revenue through proactive inventory planning, marketing campaigns, and staffing.

Business Question 2: Which regions, categories, and customer segments generate the highest revenue?

Finding

The Central region generated the highest revenue (2.82M), while the United States emerged as the company's strongest market (2.30M). Across customer segments, the Consumer segment contributed the largest share of revenue.

Business Impact

The Central region, United States, and Consumer segment represent the company's primary revenue drivers and should remain strategic priorities for investment and customer retention.

Profitability Insight

Business Question 3: Which product categories contribute the most to profit?

Finding

The Technology category generated the highest profit, making it the company's strongest contributor to overall profitability.

Business Impact

Technology products should remain a strategic focus while management reviews lower-performing categories to identify opportunities for margin improvement.

Discount Insight

Business Question 4: How do discounts affect profitability?

Finding

The analysis shows a negative relationship between discounts and profit. As discount levels increase, profitability generally declines, with heavily discounted transactions more likely to generate low or negative profits.

Business Impact

Discounting should be carefully controlled. Establishing discount thresholds and regularly monitoring their impact can help improve overall profit margins.

Customer Insight

Business Question 5: Who are the Company's most valuable customers

The company serves 795 customers, with revenue concentrated among a relatively small group of high-value accounts. Tom Ashbrook generated the highest sales (40.5K), followed by Tamara Chand, Greg Tran, Christopher Conant, and Sean Miller. While these customers represent only a small fraction of the customer base, they contribute significantly to overall revenue.

Business Impact

Retaining high-value customers should be a strategic priority. Strengthening relationships through loyalty programs, personalized engagement, and dedicated account management can help protect revenue while reducing customer churn.

Products Requiring Immediate Review

Business Question 6: Which products require management attention?

Several premium products, including the Cubify CubeX 3D Printer Double Head, Lexmark MX611dhe Laser Printer, and Motorola Smart Phone, consistently generated losses despite their high market value. These losses may stem from excessive discounting, high procurement costs, warranty expenses, or poor pricing strategies.

Business Impact

Management should review these products to determine whether losses are driven by excessive discounting, high procurement costs, warranty expenses, or pricing strategies. If profitability cannot be improved, discontinuing or repositioning these products should be considered.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the findings from this analysis, the following actions are recommended to improve sales performance and profitability.

Optimize Discount Strategy

Review and standardize discount policies to prevent excessive discounting that erodes profit margins.

Capitalize on Peak Sales Periods

Increase inventory, marketing campaigns, and operational capacity ahead of Q4 to maximize revenue during the strongest sales season.

01

02

03

Improve Performance in Low-Margin Markets

Investigate regions and countries with strong sales but weak profitability to identify pricing, cost, or operational inefficiencies.

Review Loss-Making Products

Assess the pricing, procurement costs, and profitability of consistently loss-making products. Consider repricing, renegotiating supplier costs, or discontinuing products that remain unprofitable.

Retain High-Value Customers

Develop loyalty initiatives and personalized engagement strategies for top customers to strengthen long-term customer retention.

04

05

06

Build on High-Performing Markets

Leverage the strategies driving success in the Central region and the United States to improve performance in underperforming markets.